

Maria Silva

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02 September 2026

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Competition Litigation Paralegal role at Ryder Reid Legal because competition litigation sits at the intersection of procedural complexity and substantive commercial law, and my background in supporting complex disputes at Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner gives me directly relevant experience.

At BCLP's International Arbitration team, I supported a significant investment arbitration from evidence review through to the filing of the Claimant's memorial. I organised and reviewed documentary evidence for procedural submissions, drafted procedural histories and orders, and amended sections of the memorial itself. Shortly before a major deadline, I became the only junior supporting the team and was responsible for coordinating outstanding documents and tracking actions to ensure on-time submission. The feedback I received from the partner and associate was that my performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor. That experience gave me a clear understanding of what case management in high-stakes litigation actually requires: structured file organisation, accurate deadline tracking, and the ability to work under pressure without letting quality slip.

The Real Estate Disputes rotation added a different dimension. I supported hearing preparation by reviewing documents, preparing electronic bundles, and assisting with court materials and skeleton arguments across several matters running simultaneously. Managing competing deadlines across a high volume of documents, while keeping matter records current in iManage, is directly comparable to what a competition litigation paralegal would be doing day to day.

My Citizens Advice work has developed a different but complementary skill. I take detailed factual statements, construct chronologies, identify evidential gaps, and translate complex procedural requirements into clear guidance for clients who are often in difficult circumstances. The ability to extract what matters from a large factual picture and communicate it clearly is as useful in litigation support as in advice work.

Competition litigation appeals to me specifically because of its procedural depth and the scale of the matters involved, particularly class actions where case management is central to how the litigation runs. My LLM in Comparative and International Dispute Resolution has developed my understanding of procedural frameworks and how evidence is handled across different legal systems, which I think is relevant background for a team operating at the level described.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss the role further.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva